

TrailMark Project OS

00 - TrailMark Constitution v1.0

Mission

TrailMark exists to become the world's finest illustrated archive of America's National Parks. Every decision should strengthen wonder, education, craftsmanship, and lifelong memories. We are not building a travel website—we are building an experience people remember.

Golden Rule

When there is uncertainty, choose the solution that makes visitors fall more deeply in love with the National Parks, not the solution that is easier to code.

Product Identity

Premium • Timeless • Educational • Artistic • Emotional • Collectible • Calm • Inspiring. Never generic. Never trendy. Never rushed.

Design Philosophy

Every screen should feel like Apple-quality software mixed with National Geographic, a beautifully illustrated field journal, and a museum archive.

User Experience Philosophy

Technology disappears. Nature becomes the focus. Every interaction should create wonder, curiosity, understanding, or memory.

Five Feature Tests

Before implementing a feature ask: (1) Does it deepen appreciation for the park? (2) Does it teach something meaningful? (3) Does it improve the visitor's real experience? (4) Does it strengthen the TrailMark archive? (5) Will it still feel timeless in ten years? If not, don't build it.

Development Philosophy

Build in small, polished increments. Never rush. Never ship 'good enough.' Quality compounds.

Scope Control

Current focus is Phase 1: complete the TrailMark Website. Do not jump to unrelated systems or future platforms.

Current Priority

Homepage, Yosemite master template, remaining 62 parks, search, navigation, badge archive, posters, responsive design, accessibility, performance, SEO.

Coding Rules

Understand the existing architecture before editing. Improve existing systems when possible. Keep components reusable. Avoid duplication. Respect accessibility, performance, and responsive design.

Design Rules

Maintain spacing rhythm, typography hierarchy, illustration-first storytelling, editorial pacing, minimal motion, and premium interactions.

AI Rules

The AI should challenge ideas professionally when a better solution exists. Don't agree blindly. Recommend improvements with reasoning.

Project OS Integration

Read the TrailMark Project OS before major work. Follow existing standards whenever available.

Version 2 Trigger

If development reveals a reusable system affecting multiple parks or future features, recommend documenting it as a Project OS Version 2 document before expanding further.

Workflow

Understand → Plan → Build → Validate → Improve. Never skip validation or leave work half-finished.

Final Question

Before every major milestone ask: 'If Apple, National Geographic, and the National Park Service built this together, would they be proud of it?' If not, continue refining.

Companion File

Create a second document named '01 - Current Phase.md' that defines the active milestone, current goals, out-of-scope work, and the rule to capture future ideas without losing focus.